IMPERIAL
BUSINESS SCHOOL

How best to use AI as a learner – Student Guidance

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Key takeaways: When using AI to support your learning be intentional. Decide whether AI helps before you start and know when to stop. Some tasks are best done without it. AI should supplement your learning rather than replacing it. Always cross-check what it gives you and remember that your module materials come first. For assessments, you are the accountable author of everything you submit, so be prepared to explain and defend what you submit if asked. Check your assessment instructions to see if it is an AI-off or AI-on assessment before you start. Using AI in an AI-off assessment or asking AI to produce the final output for an AI-on assessment are both considered academic misconduct. Use Imperial's supported AI technologies on dAIsy or Microsoft Copilot for your studies. Never share your Imperial credentials, personal information or the work of others without permission. Ask if you are unsure about AI in your studies at Imperial.

We recognise that many of our students use AI to support them in their studies. In the Business School, we encourage you to do so in a way that is responsible. This guidance gives general principles you should follow. It complements the discussion in your induction workshop on Learning to Learn with AI, your Study Skills Primer materials, the university An Introduction to GenAI for Students Course and the university Generative AI and Study Guidance Hub. Make use of all these resources and if you are unsure of anything ask your module teachers or programme teams.

What do we mean by AI?

We use the general term AI to refer to use of Generative AI (Gen AI) to produce text, code, images, audio or video, to agentic AI that can carry out multi-step tasks, and to machine learning practices used for pattern recognition and learning analytics.

What AI Application to use, and when to use it?

Currently, dAIsy (with multiple technologies including ChatGPT and Claude) and Microsoft Copilot are available for free to all Imperial students and are the recommended and supported AI technologies.

On dAIsy, your conversations are not visible to others and the data you provide is not used to train the models. Microsoft Copilot is available under an enterprise licence, and when logged in to your Imperial account offers its own data protection. With other AI technologies your data may be stored, analysed, sold to third parties or used for training future AI models. Always read the privacy policy.

If you ever feel at a disadvantage because of the cost of AI technologies not provided by Imperial, please discuss with your module lead or the programme team.

Responsible Use of AI to support your learning

AI can play a part in supporting your learning if you use it in a responsible way. The Imperial Generative AI Principles provide an excellent starting point for understanding what Responsible Use means in the context of your studies. They relate to the critical and ethical use of AI and the evaluation of its use and impact. Please get familiar with them.

On ethical use, be mindful of the impact of your use on the planet and on operating costs (even if you don't incur them directly). Think first before providing personal or identifying information of yourself or others. With any sources that you use with AI technologies, consider if you have permission to use

that information in that way and understand how the information is used by the AI technology, and the company behind it. Take care with work under licence such as journal articles or textbooks obtained through Imperial's publisher agreements. Work produced by your module leaders is their property. You should check if you have permission to upload to AI. Never give an AI technology your Imperial credentials or access to an Imperial-linked system.

On learning, always remember that materials curated and produced by your module leader are your primary source of information for your studies. Make them the foundation for your learning. Don't forget you can also discuss your ideas with the module lead in office hours and your peers are also a useful fount of knowledge to discuss your ideas with.

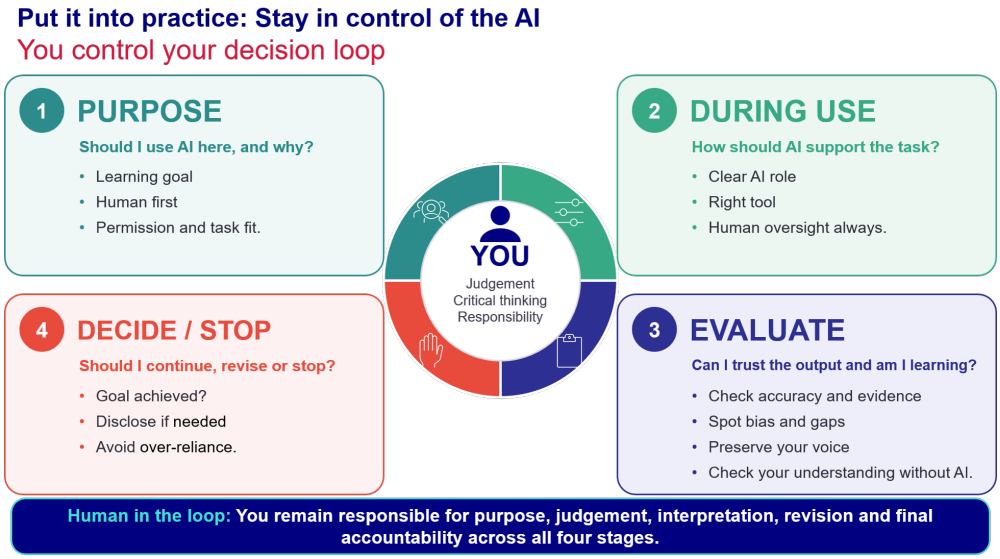
Responsible Use of AI technologies can support your learning further. For example AI can help produce a synthesis using existing sources of knowledge. You can also, with well written instructions, generate additional interesting and relevant output. This should always be supplementary to, not instead of, the module materials and opportunities to learn with and from the people around you. Also be mindful that AI can generate content, but finding information is not the same as learning. You will need to be able to speak to your ideas with your peers and your teachers. Check-in on how much you can recall after a period of time, and how much you can explain to someone else without AI.

You have the opportunity to use AI to personalise and deepen your learning. For example, you could use AI for the following elements of learning.

- Exploring: Ideas for topics, cases, literature.
- Checking: Concepts, understanding, questions.
- Producing: Summaries, explanations, examples.
- Activity creation: Flash cards, quizzes, other study aids.

You must always cross-check what you have found, recognising that AI is not always accurate or the most relevant academic source. You should also be careful when using AI to finesse your writing as there is a risk that your voice and point will get lost and what it suggests may not align with professional academic writing standards. It is also important to remember that the final output for an assessment must be written by you which means that you cannot ask AI to rewrite something of yours, for example to 'fix' your writing or to translate. You can of course ask it for suggestions to improve your writing but you need to make choices about what to change so that you retain full ownership of the output.

As discussed in your Learning to Learn with AI Induction Sessions, a central tenet of being responsible is being intentional about your AI use. Some tasks are best done independently, especially where the effort itself is part of the learning. If you decide AI has a role to play, follow the decision-making loop below, discussed in the induction workshop.



It is imperative that you are critical and reflective in your use of AI to maximise learning and to develop skills for the workplace. There is a table in your programme handbook that outlines the most important Employability Skills for an AI World and you will see critical thinking, reflection and responsible use there.

How to use AI for assessments?

Assessments at the Business School are either AI-off or AI-on.

- **AI-off assessments**: any situation where you have to deliver an output without AI assistance. Includes live presentations, invigilated on-campus written exams, oral exams, in-class participation, and in-class timed quizzes. You can use AI for revision purposes but make sure you are preparing in a way that supports your learning for that specific assessment. It is academic misconduct to use AI during the assessment.
- **AI-on assessments:** no one is observing whether or how you use AI with the assessment preparation, but you are not permitted to ask AI to produce your final output; in the same way you cannot ask a friend, family member or a paid third party. You are the final author of the output with responsibility and accountability for what is submitted.

Where a marker has a concern about inappropriate use of AI, you can be required to discuss with them in an Authenticity Interview. This is a meeting with the module lead and a member of the Business School Education Quality team where you are expected to show you understand what was submitted, explain how the work was produced and discuss why you made the choices you made. If a module lead is concerned about AI use on any submitted assessment they will ask the Education Quality team to contact the student, or students, and a meeting will be set up for this authenticity interview. If after the discussion the module lead remains concerned the matter is referred to the university Academic Integrity team who will instigate an Academic Misconduct investigation. An academic panel would determine appropriate penalties where it is determined that there was inappropriate use of AI. Remember on group assessments, you are collectively responsible for the authenticity of the final output and would be asked to answer to any queries as a team. We recommend you retain an audit trail of your contribution, including how you made use of AI.

Your assessment brief will tell you whether that piece of work is AI-on or AI-off. It will set out anything specific to that assessment. For example, for a presentation, the assessment brief may tell you that you are not permitted to read from a script on a device or paper. In some assessments, you will be required to use AI and be assessed on how well you use it in the context of that module. The brief will also explain, if required, how to acknowledge how you used AI for an assessment. Follow their instructions and the Library Generative AI Guidance. Make sure you are familiar with the marking criteria, which generally put more weight on what humans can do well, and what AI does less well.

You will see a lot of variation in approaches across your modules so always ask the module leaders for clarification if you are unsure about your AI use for assessments.

Talk to faculty about their use of AI for their teaching and ask for help

You may wonder how faculty are using AI for their teaching. Ask them. They are expected to use AI responsibly, are accountable for what they produce and are encouraged to disclose their usage. We do not currently use AI for marking or producing feedback in the Business School. Markers may ask AI to help them refine their draft feedback for clarity and to ensure it aligns with their marking criteria but are not currently permitted to upload student work directly to AI to create the feedback which is based on their academic judgement.

You should also talk to them if you are ever unsure whether your use of AI is supporting your learning.